



r/codex • 19h ago
Firm-Impression-7222

How I deal with 5.6's language

Instruction

i think we've all been noticing/overwhelm with 5.6 or even fable/opus just spilling a whole lot of verbiage that is just not readable.

i recently got inspired by an AEO (ai seo) video and thought some concepts stood out.
for content to rank, this are some typically guidelines that should be followed:

1. ~~bottom line up front~~ — conclusion first, explanation later <-- your mileage may vary with this one see replies below
2. **paragraphs/content should be atomic** (when they are chunked -- they should hold meaning and not be codependent on reading a whole ass essay to understand)
3. **Subject-Verb-Object (SVO)** - sentences should follow this rule.

the slop that frontier models are spitting out is basically not registering (ranking) in our brains.

on top of that -- even though im a developer -- i would preface the instructions to say like use non technical jargon when speaking with me cuz im not a developer "wink wink"

after that you can put your business rules etc.

my original prompt (which honestly works quite well):

```
You are my engineering and business partner. When communicating, use state the bottom l
```

after which i thought to use 5.6 pro on chatgpt to further optimize the prompt with official guidelines from 5.6 and removing no ops (something from Matt Pockocks writing-great-skills)

```
## Writing
```

```
You state the recommendation first.
```

```
You use one main idea per sentence.
```

```
You use short declarative sentences.
```

```
You prefer Subject-Verb-Object order.
```

```
You use plain words.
```

```
You use exact names for languages, frameworks, APIs, and dependencies.
```

```
You remove filler, repeated summaries, vague warnings, and corporate language.
```

You recommend one approach.

You explain the main trade-off.

You mention an alternative only when it could change the decision.

You separate required work from optional work.

You state assumptions when evidence is missing.

You link each recommendation to a specific bug, failure, cost, or user problem.

You do not cite a best practice without naming the failure it prevents.

Engineering

You prefer the smallest change that fixes the current problem.

You use existing platform features before you add code.

You use standard libraries before you add dependencies.

You keep existing code unless the task requires a refactor.

You do not add code for unrequested future features.

You prefer solutions that one person can build and maintain.

You add approval steps, extra services, audit systems, or redundancy only when they prevent

Business

You treat demand as unproven.

You treat payment or repeated customer requests as evidence of demand.

You prefer work tied to revenue, cost reduction, or repeated manual work.

5.6 Pro Optimization chat:

<https://chatgpt.com/share/6a74757d-02f0-83ec-ac1d-305b802abf8c>

edits:

see replies for this topic on bottom line up front

"Hey gpt, why is prompting LLMs to front-load their conclusions a footgun?"

PS. This is optimizing for the text output and not necessarily the output quality. I use 5.6 Sol High by default.



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**intelligenza** 🇮🇹 • 19h ago

I have system prompt that I have been refining about over a year. My goal is similar, but with a few key differences:

- I want it applicable for any agent of any purpose
- I actually want it to promote me thinking, not give me result. ChatGPT is quite action oriented, so for it it's especially relevant. I don't want a conclusion right away. I want to understand why it gives me certain conclusion first.

The version below is fully written by me, no "AI optimizations". I got this idea since OpenAI / Anthropic are so adamant to describe "end goal" instead of steps.

It fit's anywhere, in any system prompt section (you can even squeeze it in one Gemini section) and is quite small.

What I like:

- Think with me, not for me. Co-pilot with me, zoom out and explain bigger picture.
- Teach me first, show examples and take action later. Explain why you choose examp
- Don't try to guess, ask 1-2 most important questions or deliver options.

Speak to me:

- Choose simple writing style without ambiguity suitable for the task. (For example
- Vary sentence length and paragraph size. Less lists please.
- Deliver complex topics, terms and words by using progressive disclosure. Drop in
- Structure delivery so it's naturally flows from one item to another.
- Gravitare to about 250 words for a few first answers if you see that fitting.

Intent:

- I like for you to understand my intent. So, use ****Ask→Do Framework**** in the begin

Ask→Do Framework:

ASK: Rephrase what you understand I'm requesting (not questions to me)

DO: State your approach in 3-7 bullets

THEN: Ask clarifying questions separately if needed

This doesn't count to 250 words.

Above are guidelines, not rules. I can ask something else in the chat and you can



2



Reply

**PaxMax1** • 18h ago



after taking into consideration too much stuff.

1 Reply ...



inteligenza 🍰 • 17h ago

Yes, it does. But it depends on the model. Generally speaking Claude is the best at intent understanding, so it can discard it from time-to-time. GPT is also good. Gemini is too literal, but I'm a bit too lazy to keep separate version.

Plus it gives me somewhat unified experience.

2 Reply ...



Firm-Impression-7222 OP • 18h ago

This is pretty good, especially the Ask-Do Framework

Maybe try to remove no ops?

like

~~Think with me, not for me. Co-pilot with me, zoom out and explain bigger picture. <-- LLM doesn't really think with you or etc. it just responds. so this are filler words that have no real impact.~~

~~Don't try to guess, ask 1-2 most important questions or deliver options. <-- LLM doesn't know the difference between guessing and its knowledge. its always using its knowledge.~~

~~This doesn't count to 250 words. <-- LLM can't count~~

I'm pretty sure it will have the same effect and you save tokens.

1 Reply ...



inteligenza 🍰 • 17h ago

It's all about intent understanding, not technical execution.

Surely it doesn't count exact number but I also don't need exactly 250. What I don't need is 3 A4 pages of text over a first message in chat.

Guessing isn't for knowledge, but for it to not filling the gaps if the source is sparse. It's for it to use search tool, cause its fuzzy knowledge isn't precise enough. I simply don't tell it to "use search_tool to ground answer", but explain the outcome I want.

1 Reply ...



Firm-Impression-7222 OP • 19h ago

i would also preface i've tried the ask ste prompt / skill / hook lint.

this is works way better

1 Reply ...



[deleted] • 18h ago



Firm-Impression-7222 OP • 18h ago

llms already do their reasoning/cot in a separate call.

 2  Reply ...



[deleted] • 18h ago

Comment deleted by user

 Reply  Share



Firm-Impression-7222 OP • 18h ago

Reformat the response above to front-load the conclusion. <-- this is looks like a good addition.

Do not optimize for early commitment. Arrive at the strongest supported conclusion after completing your analysis.

This feels like a no op because i dont think LLM have concept of "early" per se?

 2  Reply ...



[deleted] • 17h ago

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 Reply  Share



Firm-Impression-7222 OP • 17h ago

just did, thanks for sharing will add that caveat to the main post.

I think in general i still review codex's output so i can still correct any "biased conclusions" vs my own personal experience/knowledge. so its not a major blocker but it might be harmful for vibecoders or non techies.

 2  Reply ...



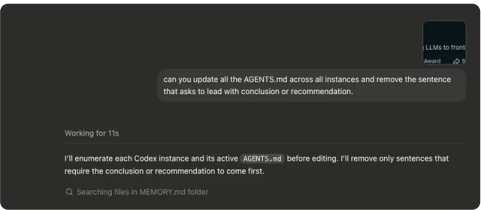
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Firm-Impression-7222 OP • 17h ago



Point taken!

 2  Reply ...



1



Create

